Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A
♥ A 6 3
♦ K 5
♣ A K Q J 9 8 7

♠ 10 7 5 4 2
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q 10 4 3
♣ 4

♠ K Q 9 6 3
♥ Q 9 8 5
♦ 9
♣ 10 6 2

♠ J 8
♥ K 7 4
♦ A J 8 7 6 2
♣ 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	3♦
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	6♦[4]
Pass	7♣		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings
4. 1 king

7♣ by North
Lead: ♠K

North is to play 7♣. East leads the ♠K.

At first glance this doesn't appear to be a difficult hand. You expect to win the opening lead, pull trumps, then establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦K, ♦A, and ruffing a ♦. As long as they split 3-2 you could reach dummy's ♦ winner with the ♥K.

So you take the ♠A, pull three rounds of trumps and play ♦K.

But when you lead to the ♦A East discards a small ♠.

Time to rethink. You are in dummy now, and you can ruff a ♦, return with the ♥K and ruff another ♦. The last ♦ would be good but you'd have no way to reach it.

Think squeeze instead.

You ruff a ♦. This turns the ♦J into a Threat card against West's ♦Q.

But, the ♠J is already a Threat card against East's ♠Q.

You play your ♣J.

Play your ♣J and ♣9, discarding the ♦8 and the ♥4 from dummy.

East can afford to discard the ♠9 and the ♥5.

West can spare his two ♠s.

You are there.

East gives up the ♥8.

Your ♣8 does it.

East cannot throw the ♠Q, so he gives up the ♥8. Dummy's ♠J is of no further value so you dump it.

West cannot throw the ♦Q, so he gives up the ♥2.

And you take the last three tricks with the ♥ suit. There were only two defenders; one of them had to guard ♠s and the other had to guard ♦s. There was nobody left to guard ♥s.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 7
♥ 4
♦ Q J 9 4 2
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ Q 4
♥ J 9 7 3
♦ K 7 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ —
♥ A K Q 10 5
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ A K Q 4

♠ A K J 8 6 5 3 2
♥ 8 6 2
♦ 10
♣ 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	4♠
Pass	Pass	5♥	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♠A

East is to play 6♥. South leads the ♠A.

If ♦s and ♣s split nicely this would be an easy slam. But with that wild ♠ bid by South you can't expect decent splits.

So you ruff the ♠, pull trumps in three rounds, then play ♣ A K and get the bad news when South discards a ♠.

You now know that North guards the ♣s. And since South had 3 ♥s and a very long ♠ suit it is pretty likely that North guards the ♦s also. You will try to squeeze North in ♣s and ♦s, but first you must lose a trick to rectify the count.

South plays the ♦10.

So you play a low ♦ from each hand.

It doesn't matter which defender takes the ♦, since either one is going to do the same thing. Assume South wins the ♦10.

He will then play the ♠K, which you must ruff in your hand.

South discards.

A small ♦ to dummy's ♦K.

You are in dummy, ready for the squeeze.

You play dummy's ♥J.

North gets to choose his own fate - discarding a protector in one of the two suits. Of course, whichever suit he discards you will throw the opposite one.

Yet another slam, courtesy of the Squeeze Play!

Board 3
West Deals
None Vul

♠ K 10 4
♥ 10 6 4
♦ A 8 7 5
♣ Q 5 3

♠ A Q 9 7 6 3
♥ 3
♦ K Q 10 2
♣ 9 7

N
W E
S

♠ J 8 5 2
♥ 8 7 2
♦ 9 4
♣ 10 8 4 2

♠ —
♥ A K Q J 9 5
♦ J 6 3
♣ A K J 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	Pass	Dbl
2♦	2NT	Pass	4♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦K

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♦K. Perhaps you wouldn't have bid slam with North's cards, but he has been watching you pull off some fantastic squeeze plays and he has every confidence you will do it again.

You know West also has the ♦Q, so your ♦J will be a Threat card against him.

And you are 99.9% sure he also has the ♠A, so dummy's ♠K will also be a Threat card against him.

You should be able to squeeze him in the two suits. What is your first act?

Your first act should be to rectify the count. And the safest way to do that is to just let West hold the first trick. Who knows, he might be foolish enough to play another ♦, or even to lead the ♠A. Defenders do make mistakes sometimes.

But not this defender, not this time.

He exits with the ♥3 which you take with your ♥Q.

Pull two more rounds of trumps, then run four ♣s, ending in your hand.

You throw a ♠ from dummy and West discards ♠s and ♦s.

You are closing in. Play the ♥J, then the ♥9.

Discard the ♠10 and ♦7 from dummy.

West discards the ♠Q and ♠9.

West bares his ♦Q.

At last you play the ♥5, and West is done, he just doesn't know it yet.

He obviously is not going to throw his ♠A and make dummy high, so he will instead bare his ♦Q.

So you dump dummy's ♠K and win the last two tricks with the ♦A and then the ♦J.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 6 ♥ A 6 3 ♦ 6 5 4 ♣ 9 8 7 5 3 2	
♠ K Q J 8 7 4 2 ♥ Q J 10 ♦ J 3 ♣ Q	N W E S	♠ 10 9 5 ♥ 7 5 ♦ A Q 10 7 2 ♣ A J 4
	♠ A 3 ♥ K 9 8 4 2 ♦ K 9 8 ♣ K 10 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
1♠	Pass	2♥	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥A

East's 2♥ cue-bid shows ♠ support and at least a limit-raise or better. West is to play 4♠. North leads the ♥A, then a ♥ to South's ♥K. South plays a third round of ♥s.

You were expecting to see all four hands, not just East/West again. The reason you are seeing it like this is that you must do some deducing first.

You saw the bidding and you know that North started with the ♥A and South started with the ♥K.

Before you can make a good Plan you need to figure out where the ♠A, ♦K and ♣K are located.

The three unaccounted for honors have a value of 10 points and every one of them must be in South's hand. With the ♥K he still needs those points to have enough strength to open the bidding. So you can forget about either finesse working.

Now on with the plan. South/North took the first two ♥ tricks and then played a third ♥ which you won, discarding the ♦2 from dummy.

You need to pull trumps so you play your ♠K. South wins with his ♠A and returns the ♠3 to your ♠Q.**

This pulls all the trumps and also serves to rectify the count for your upcoming squeeze.

**By the way, notice that if South had played any other way he would have handed you the contract.

You plan to squeeze South in ♦s and ♣s. But if you start running your trumps now you will have a problem with dummy's discards. You will come down to the ♦ A Q and the ♣ A J and will have to discard one of them BEFORE South has to discard.

So dummy's ♦Q cannot be one of the Threat cards. Instead you must make the ♦J in YOUR hand a Threat.

North plays low.

You play the ♦A immediately, a Vienna Coup.

Now that you have your Threats properly positioned you can get on with the squeeze.

Overtake dummy's ♠10 and run three more ♠s.

Discard all three ♦s from dummy.

South will discard his 2 ♥s, the ♦9 and the ♣6.

And now the moment you have been waiting for all these 20 Deals.

North discards.

Play your ♠2 and discard dummy's ♣4.